

## TEST 2, WRITING TASK 1

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 5.5** score.

The presented chart illustrates the relationship between annual salary and the amount of household in three different years.

Overall, the number of household has increased in the last year (2015) and most of them have an annual income lower than \$75,000 and more than one out of three received an income lower than \$50,000. Furthermore this tendency has been stable in the 2007, 2011 and 2015.

In the chart can be observed that approximately just over twenty five million household have gotten an annual income of less than 25,000 in 2015 and almost the same number has received lower than 50,000 in the same year. As it was mention before, the patron has been the basically the same in previous years. There has been an increment of around 10 million of household who earned more or equal to \$100,000 per year in 2015.

Here is the examiner's comment:

The overview at the beginning of this response is largely irrelevant as it is just restating the task question. The response does state that the number of households [*has increased*] in 2015 and the pattern [*has been stable*] over the time given, but the information given [*most of them have an annual income lower than \$75,000 | one out of three received an income lower than \$50,000*] is largely irrelevant as these are not the main features of the chart.

The response only really covers data from 2015, referring to the earlier time spans by simply saying [*the same in previous years*]. To score more highly for this task, the candidate should present data to support this description and demonstrate how the pattern was the same in previous years.

The ideas presented are arranged coherently and, despite the missing details, there is a progression. Cohesive devices are used [*Overall | Furthermore*] but with some errors [*As it was mention before / As mentioned before*] and some lack of clarity.

Vocabulary includes the use of some less common items [*salary | tendency | stable*], but there are some errors in spelling [*ilustrates / illustrates | aproximately / approximately*] and in using the appropriate word [*patron / pattern | increment / increase*].

A range of grammatical structures is included, with examples of modals [*can be observed*]. Overall, however, there is repetition of the perfect tense [*has increased | has been | have gotten | has received*] and of comparative structures [*lower than*], with some long sentences that could have more effective punctuation.

To improve the Band Score, the response should be a minimum of 150 words and more of the information from the bar chart should be reported.